Almer Garingan

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EDUCATION & ORGANIZATION

BS, Business Administration - Management Information Systems **May 2028**

San Jose State University

- **Minor:** Computer Networking System Management
- **GPA:** 3.8/4.0

Organizations:

- **Cyber Intelligence & Security (CIS):** Workshops, CTF challenges, labs, and competitions
- **Network Engineering Technology Society (NETS):** workshops and mini-labs
- **Akbayan Pilipinx American:** Hosted and organized workshops, events, and check-ins

EXPERIENCE

Hydroficient **Remote**

Cyber Security Extern ***Jan. 2026 – Jul. 2026***

- Engineered a secure **MQTT-based IoT pipeline** using **Python, TLS encryption**, and **device certificates** to authenticate connections while protecting real-time data on **3+** water monitoring systems
- Conducted security testing, including replay attack simulations, TLS performance benchmarking, and penetration testing against MQTT broker endpoints, identifying vulnerabilities and tuning defenses accordingly
- Developed a real-time **Streamli**t dashboard integrating live telemetry and alert data to monitor pipeline health, visualize threat activity, and track system status, cutting alert response time by **30%**

Collegiate Cyber Defense Competition **Remote**

Competitor - Linux Administrator ***Feb. 2026***

- Secured network access across all team-managed hosts during **20+** live attack scenarios by configuring and enforcing **Linux firewall rules (iptables/ufw)** to block **4** unauthorized ports and restrict lateral movement
- Hardened **SSH (sshd)** by enforcing key-based authentication, restricting access controls, and tightening configuration settings, sustaining **80%** service uptime under active attack
- Reduced attack surfaces by **50%** through auditing and managing user accounts, password policies, and permissions

Outamation **Remote**

AI and Automation Extern ***Jul. 2025 – Oct. 2025***

- Supported technical systems handling **200+** page mortgage files, ensuring data accuracy and preventing processing errors
- Configured and tested document retrieval systems, troubleshooting errors, and boosting search reliability for end-users
- Performed system evaluations to identify errors, document performance, and provide recommendations, similar to diagnosing and resolving **5+** end-user technical issues

LEADERSHIP EXPERIENCE

Cyber Intelligence & Security **San Jose, CA**

President ***Oct. 2026 – Present***

- Facilitating an officer team of **8 members** to plan out semester goals and workshops, and running weekly **CTF** and **Burp Suite meetings** for **300+ active members**
- Working with faculty advisor to create an externship with well-known companies and hosting our own **CTF Competition** for students at SJSU
- Increasing workshop attendance from **5 members** to **20+ members** through promotion on Discord, Instagram, and on campus

Cyber Intelligence & Security **San Jose, CA**

Treasurer ***Feb. 2026 – Present***

- Overseeing the club's compliance with the Associated Students of **300+ members**, resulting in **0 compliance violations**
- Managing club spending, achieving **$3,000+** in funding to supply **300+** members with inventory and equipment
- Leading club meetings and coordinating **CTF**, **workshops**, and **competitions** for over **25+** members, enhancing members' cybersecurity skills

PROJECTS

DigitalOcean HoneyPot | GitHub Documentation: github.com/AlmerGaringan/HoneyPot **Jan. 2026**

- Designed a cloud-based HoneyPot capturing **50,000+** live attacks under **24 hours**, visualized with **Elastic/Kibana**, and a real-time global attack map
- Identified credential brute-force trends across **SSH** services, extracting **50+** attackers' used usernames/passwords from live **Cowrie** logs
- Correlated attack activity across **20+** honeypot services with **Suricata IDS** detections, identifying protocol misuse, reconnaissance scanning, and mass-scanner behavior, and differentiating known attacker IPs vs. automated bot traffic

Pi-Hole | GitHub Documentation: github.com/AlmerGaringan/Pi-Hole **Dec. 2025**

- Deployed Pi-Hole **DNS** ad blocker on a Raspberry Pi 4 to manage and secure devices on the **LAN**
- Reconfigured **static IP**, **DHCP**, and **DNS** settings on a private **LAN**, ensuring consistent privacy and network stability
- Blocked **21%** of malicious queries and **96%** of **adware** over **4** devices, with over **250+** blocked queries out of **2200+** queries

TryHackMe, SOC Simulator | Profile: tryhackme.com/p/almer.garingan **Aug. 2026**

- Closed **5** simulated security incidents end-to-end using **Splunk** for log correlation and structured **SOC triage workflows**
- Investigated and triaged simulated phishing alerts involving inbound emails with suspicious external links, analyzing sender reputation and URL structure to determine malicious intent
- Analyzed firewall alerts for blocked blacklisted URL connections, applying timely log analysis and escalation decisions consistent with a **25-minute average** dwell time across simulated incidents

CERTIFICATION & SKILLS

Certification: Google Cyber Security Professional Certificate | CompTIA Security+ (In Progress)

Scripting & Automation: Python | SQL | PowerShell | Bash

Security & SOC Tools: SIEM | Splunk | Elastic/Kibana | Wireshark | Nmap | Burp Suite | Suricata IDS | Cowrie | MITRE ATT&CK

Systems, Networking & Cloud: Windows | Linux (Ubuntu, Debian, Kali) | macOS | DNS | DHCP | TCP/IP | AWS EC2 | DigitalOcean | VMware | VirtualBox | Proxmox